

threats to the security of a system, and as we put more personal data about ourselves out there, it becomes easier to gather this information.

We are often misled by the convenience of the social networking, and the fact that it seems much less personal. Most people give much less thought to making friends on social networks than they do in real life. For some it is about boasting of having more friends, others may feel it rude to reject such an innocent request. It's simpler to add friends online, even those we don't know; especially since few see the harm in this.

The fact is, the second you add someone to your friend list, they might instantly gain access to the kind of information you might not even share with your "offline" friends. Your favourite movies, songs books, interests, hobbies, your list of friends, perhaps even your phone number, address, birth-date, and nicknames are shared with your friends on social networks. All this information is something that your offline friends might only get to know over years of interacting with you, however on an online social network people simply hand it over on a simple request. It does seem to be that online friendships are more serious than offline ones.

You might wonder what the point of social engineering is. How does it relate to hacking passwords? Well the fact is, that most people choose passwords which they find easy to remember – no surprise there – and while not everyone will be choosing passwords such as "abcde" most will rely on phrases of personal relevance, names of members in their family, or friend

